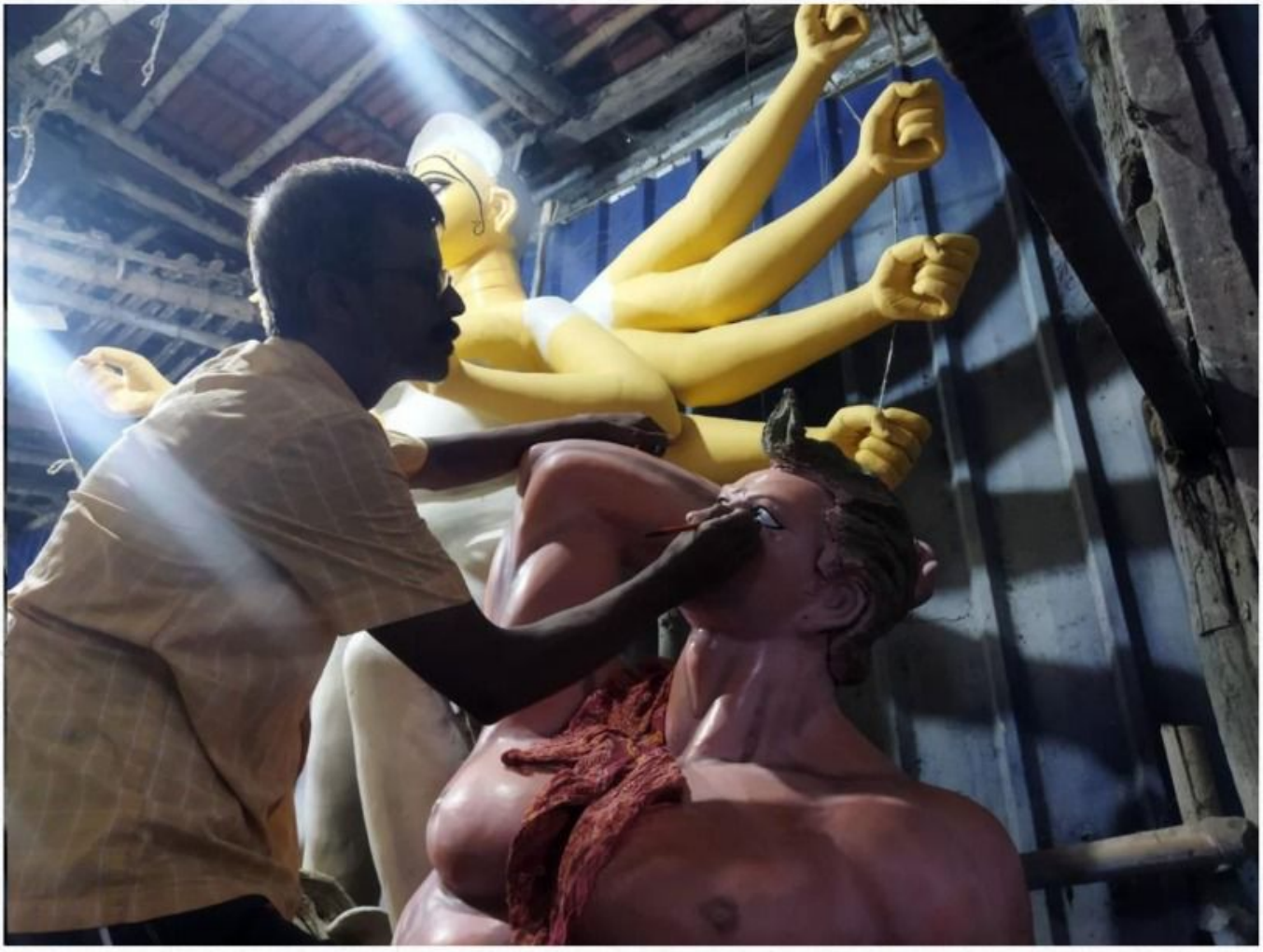
Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative November 2023

Durga Puja is over. Now it is the artisans' time to celebrate.

At last count, the economic value of the creative ecosystem of Durga Puja in West Bengal was Rs.32,377 crores - the size of the annual economy of many small countries.





UNESCO listed massArt's 2023 preview of Durga Puja locations, covering 26 locations in Kolkata, in its 20th anniversary celebration of events safeguarding the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.
(massArt is a Kolkata-based company partnered by British Council.)

Most pandal makers come from a farming background. They are self-taught or learn from masters. What they earn in the two months of Pujo activity outstrips between 60% and 100% of their yearly farm income. Contracts for July-August are signed often as early as January of that year.


এখানে গাড়ী রাখিবেন না

"As a farm labourer one neither has respectability nor money," says Biswajit Mahato, artisan from Nawadweep district, echoing the feelings of thousands of workers associated with Durga Puja art installations.

“We live for the Puja,” says another craftsperson, Nayan Metia of Purba Medinipur. “It is the time for us to showcase our artistry and improve our standing as artists.”



Read the well-written article below by Shreya Banerjee, published in The Hindu just before this year's Durga Puja, for a comprehensive report on how the festive celebrations are growing to gigantic proportions year on year, adding to the rising prosperity of artisans across West Bengal.